

Fundamentals of Tensor Computation

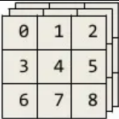
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What is a tensor?

- A tensor is just a generalization of scalars, vectors, and matrices.
- A scalar is a 0th-order Tensor, a vector is called order 1st-order Tensor, a matrix is a 2nd-order Tensor, while a 3D collection of numbers is a 3rd-order Tensor.

Order	Example	Terminology									
0	1	Scalar									
1	<table><tr><td>0</td><td>1</td><td>2</td></tr></table>	0	1	2	Vector						
0	1	2									
2	<table><tr><td>0</td><td>1</td><td>2</td></tr><tr><td>3</td><td>4</td><td>5</td></tr><tr><td>6</td><td>7</td><td>8</td></tr></table>	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	Matrix
0	1	2									
3	4	5									
6	7	8									
3	<table><tr><td>0</td><td>1</td><td>2</td></tr><tr><td>3</td><td>4</td><td>5</td></tr><tr><td>6</td><td>7</td><td>8</td></tr></table> 	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	3rd-order tensor
0	1	2									
3	4	5									
6	7	8									

A third order tensor

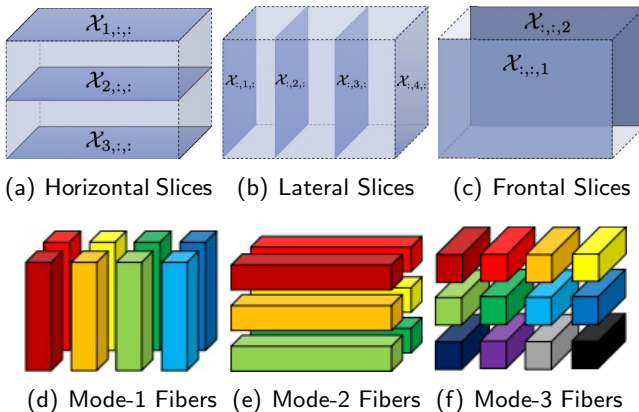
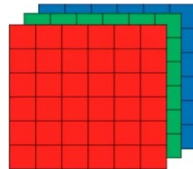
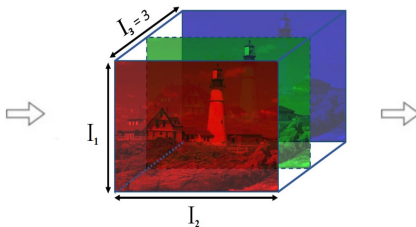


Figure: Illustration of a $3 \times 4 \times 2$ order tensor

⁰Source: https://ibug.doc.ic.ac.uk/media/uploads/documents/tensor_methods_in_computer_vision_and_deep_learning.pdf

Examples of 3rd and 4th order tensors



Color image is a 3rd-order Tensor



Color video is a 4th-order Tensor

⁰Sources: https://www.researchgate.net/publication/307091456_Quantifying_Blur_in_Color_Image_using_Higher_Order_Singular_Values,
<https://www.slideshare.net/BertonEarnshaw/a-brief-survey-of-tensors>

Algebraic operations

- k-mode product
- Tensor-tensor product
 - t-product
 - M-product
- Einstein product

k-mode product¹(tensor-matrix)

Let $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{I_1 \times I_2 \times \cdots \times I_k \times \cdots \times I_N}$ and $B \in \mathbb{R}^{J \times I_k}$. Then, their **k-mode product** is a tensor in $\mathbb{R}^{I_1 \times \cdots \times I_{k-1} \times J \times I_{k+1} \times \cdots \times I_N}$

$$(\mathcal{A} \times_k B)_{i_1 i_2 \dots i_{k-1} j i_{k+1} \dots i_N} = \sum_{i_k=1}^{I_k} a_{i_1 i_2 \dots i_{k-1} i_k i_{k+1} \dots i_N} b_{j i_k}.$$

¹Lathauwer, L. D.; Moor, B. D.; Vandewalle, J., **SIAM J. Matrix Anal. Appl.** 21 (2000) 1253-1278.

Third-order tensor product

Let $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{F}^{I \times J \times K}$, then

$$\text{bcirc}(\mathcal{A}) = \begin{bmatrix} \mathcal{A}^{(1)} & \mathcal{A}^{(K)} & \dots & \mathcal{A}^{(2)} \\ \mathcal{A}^{(2)} & \mathcal{A}^{(1)} & \dots & \mathcal{A}^{(3)} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ \mathcal{A}^{(K)} & \mathcal{A}^{(K-1)} & \dots & \mathcal{A}^{(1)} \end{bmatrix} \in \mathbb{F}^{IK \times JK}.$$

¹Kilmer, M. E.; Martin, C. D., [Linear Algebra Appl.](#) 435 (2011), 641-658.

Third-order tensor product

Let $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{F}^{I \times J \times K}$, then

$$\text{unfold}(\mathcal{A}) = \begin{bmatrix} \mathcal{A}^{(1)} \\ \mathcal{A}^{(2)} \\ \vdots \\ \mathcal{A}^{(K)} \end{bmatrix} \in \mathbb{F}^{IK \times J}$$

The $\text{fold}(\cdot)$ is the inverse operation, that is $\text{fold}(\text{unfold}(\mathcal{B})) = \mathcal{B}$.

¹Kilmer, M. E.; Martin, C. D., [Linear Algebra Appl.](#) 435 (2011), 641-658.

t-product²

Let $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{F}^{I \times J \times K}$ and $\mathcal{B} \in \mathbb{F}^{J \times L \times K}$. Then the t -product $\mathcal{A} * \mathcal{B}$ is the tensor in $\mathbb{F}^{I \times L \times K}$ defined as

$$\mathcal{A} * \mathcal{B} = \text{fold}(\text{bcirc}(\mathcal{A})\text{unfold}(\mathcal{B})).$$

²Kilmer, M. E.; Martin, C. D., [Linear Algebra Appl.](#) 435 (2011), 641-658.

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- $\mathcal{A} * \mathcal{B} = \text{ifft}(\text{fft}(\mathcal{A}, [], 3) \triangle \text{fft}(\mathcal{B}, [], 3), [], 3).$

²Kilmer, M. E.; Martin, C. D., [Linear Algebra Appl.](#) 435 (2011), 641-658.

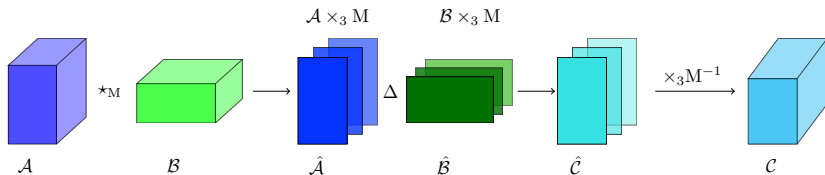
Third-order tensor product

*M-product³

Let $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{C}^{m \times n \times p}$ and $\mathcal{B} \in \mathbb{C}^{n \times \ell \times p}$, and $\mathbf{M} \in \mathbb{C}^{p \times p}$ be an invertible tensor. Then, their *M-product is a tensor $\mathcal{C} \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times \ell \times p}$, and is defined as

$$\mathcal{A} *_M \mathcal{B} = [(\mathcal{A} \times_3 \mathbf{M}) \Delta (\mathcal{B} \times_3 \mathbf{M})] \times_3 \mathbf{M}^{-1},$$

where Δ denotes the facewise product of tensors.



³Kernfeld, E.; Kilmer, M. E.; Aeron, S., *Linear Algebra Appl.* 485 (2015), 545-570.

Einstein product⁴

The Einstein product, $\mathcal{A} *_N \mathcal{B}$, of tensors $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{C}^{I_1 \times \dots \times I_M \times K_1 \times \dots \times K_N}$ and $\mathcal{B} \in \mathbb{C}^{K_1 \times \dots \times K_N \times J_1 \times \dots \times J_L}$ is a tensor in $\mathbb{C}^{I_1 \times \dots \times I_M \times J_1 \times \dots \times J_L}$ and is defined elementwise

$$(\mathcal{A} *_N \mathcal{B})_{i_1 \dots i_M j_1 \dots j_L} = \sum_{k_1, \dots, k_N=1}^{K_1, \dots, K_N} a_{i_1 \dots i_M k_1 \dots k_N} b_{k_1 \dots k_N j_1 \dots j_L}.$$

⁴Einstein, A., *The foundation of the general theory of relativity*. In: Kox AJ, Klein MJ, Schulmann R, editors. The collected papers of Albert Einstein 6. Princeton (NJ): Princeton University Press; 2007.p. 146-200.

Step back to the matrix SVD

Singular Value Decomposition

For any $A \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n}$,

$$A = U\Sigma V^T,$$

where the matrices U and V are orthogonal and the matrix Σ is diagonal with positive real entries.

⁴Lathauwer, L. D.; Moor, B. D.; Vandewalle, J., *SIAM J. Matrix Anal. Appl.* 21 (2000) 1253-1278.

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k -mode product⁵

Let $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{I_1 \times I_2 \times \cdots \times I_k \times \cdots \times I_N}$ and $B \in \mathbb{R}^{J \times I_k}$.

Then, their k -mode product is a tensor in $\mathbb{R}^{I_1 \times \cdots \times I_{k-1} \times J \times I_{k+1} \times \cdots \times I_N}$

$$(\mathcal{A} \times_k B)_{i_1 i_2 \dots i_{k-1} j i_{k+1} \dots i_N} = \sum_{i_k=1}^{I_k} a_{i_1 i_2 \dots i_{k-1} i_k i_{k+1} \dots i_N} b_{j i_k}.$$

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$$\begin{aligned} U \cdot A &= A \times_1 U, \\ A \cdot U^T &= A \times_2 U. \end{aligned}$$

⁵Lathauwer, L. D.; Moor, B. D.; Vandewalle, J., *SIAM J. Matrix Anal. Appl.* 21 (2000) 1253-1278.

Step back to the matrix SVD

Singular Value Decomposition

For any $A \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n}$,

$$A = U \Sigma V^T = \Sigma \times_1 U \times_2 V,$$

where the matrices U and V are orthogonal and the matrix Σ is diagonal with positive real entries.

k -mode product⁵

Let $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{I_1 \times I_2 \times \cdots \times I_k \times \cdots \times I_N}$ and $B \in \mathbb{R}^{J \times I_k}$.

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⁵Lathauwer, L. D.; Moor, B. D.; Vandewalle, J., *SIAM J. Matrix Anal. Appl.* 21 (2000) 1253-1278.

Extension to Higher Dimension

Mode- n Unfolding

Let $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{l_1 \times l_2 \times \cdots \times l_N}$. The mode- n unfolding, $\mathcal{A}_{(n)} \in \mathbb{R}^{l_n \times (l_1 \cdot l_2 \cdots l_{n-1} \cdot l_{n+1} \cdots l_N)}$, contains the element $a_{i_1 i_2 \cdots i_N}$ at the position with row number i_n and column number equal to

$$\begin{aligned} & (i_1 - 1) l_2 l_3 \cdots l_{n-1} + (i_2 - 1) l_3 l_4 \cdots l_{n-1} + i_{n-1} + \cdots \\ & + (i_{n+1} - 1) l_1 l_2 \cdots l_{n-1} l_{n+2} l_{n+3} \cdots l_N \\ & + (i_{n+2} - 1) l_1 l_2 \cdots l_{n-1} l_{n+3} l_{n+4} \cdots l_N + \cdots + (i_N - 1) l_1 l_2 \cdots l_{n-1}. \end{aligned}$$

Extension to Higher Dimension

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Let $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{l_1 \times l_2 \times \dots \times l_N}$. The mode- n unfolding, $\mathcal{A}_{(n)} \in \mathbb{R}^{l_n \times (l_1 \cdot l_2 \dots l_{n-1} \cdot l_{n+1} \dots l_N)}$, contains the element $a_{i_1 i_2 \dots i_N}$ at the position with row number i_n and column number equal to

$$\begin{aligned} & (i_1 - 1) l_2 l_3 \dots l_{n-1} + (i_2 - 1) l_3 l_4 \dots l_{n-1} + i_{n-1} + \dots \\ & + (i_{n+1} - 1) l_1 l_2 \dots l_{n-1} l_{n+2} l_{n+3} \dots l_N \\ & + (i_{n+2} - 1) l_1 l_2 \dots l_{n-1} l_{n+3} l_{n+4} \dots l_N + \dots + (i_N - 1) l_1 l_2 \dots l_{n-1}. \end{aligned}$$

Example

Define a tensor $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{3 \times 2 \times 3}$ by $a_{111} = a_{112} = a_{211} = -a_{212} = 1$, $a_{213} = a_{311} = a_{313} = a_{121} = a_{122} = a_{221} = -a_{222} = 2$, $a_{223} = a_{321} = a_{323} = 4$, $a_{113} = a_{312} = a_{123} = a_{322} = 0$. The matrix unfolding $\mathbf{A}_{(1)}$ is given by

$$\mathbf{A}_{(1)} = \left(\begin{array}{ccc|ccc} 1 & 1 & 0 & 2 & 2 & 0 \\ 1 & -1 & 2 & 2 & -2 & 4 \\ 2 & 0 & 2 & 4 & 0 & 4 \end{array} \right).$$

Higher-order Singular Value Decomposition⁶

Let $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{I_1 \times I_2 \times \cdots \times I_N}$. Then,

$$\mathcal{A} = \mathcal{S} \times_1 \mathbf{U}^{(1)} \times_2 \mathbf{U}^{(2)} \times_3 \cdots \times_N \mathbf{U}^{(N)},$$

- where $\mathbf{U}^{(n)}$ is determined from the SVD of mode- n unfolding, $\mathcal{A}_{(n)}$, of tensor $\mathcal{A}$, say,

$$\mathcal{A}_{(n)} = \mathbf{U}^{(n)} \cdot \boldsymbol{\Sigma}^{(n)} \cdot \mathbf{V}^{(n)T}.$$

- Compute $\mathcal{S} = \mathcal{A} \times_1 \mathbf{U}^{(1)T} \times_2 \mathbf{U}^{(2)T} \times_3 \cdots \times_N \mathbf{U}^{(N)T}$.

⁶Lathauwer, L. D.; Moor, B. D.; Vandewalle, J., *SIAM J. Matrix Anal. Appl.* 21 (2000) 1253-1278.

*M-product

Let $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n \times p}$, $\mathcal{B} \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times k \times p}$ and $M \in \mathbb{R}^{p \times p}$. Then the *M-product of tensors $\mathcal{A}$ and $\mathcal{B}$ is denoted by $\mathcal{A} *_M \mathcal{B} \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times k \times p}$ and defined as

$$\mathcal{A} *_M \mathcal{B} = [(\mathcal{A} \times_3 M) \Delta (\mathcal{B} \times_3 M)] \times_3 M^{-1}.$$

⁶Kernfeld, E.; Kilmer, M.; Aeron, S., [Linear Algebra Appl.](#) 485 (2015), 545-570.

Extension to Higher Dimension

Tensor transpose⁷

Let $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n \times p}$ and $M \in \mathbb{R}^{p \times p}$ be an invertible matrix. Then its transpose under $\star_M$ product is denoted by $\mathcal{A}^T$ and is defined as

$$\mathcal{A}^T(:, :, i) = \left(\hat{\mathcal{A}}^T \times_3 M^{-1} \right) (:, :, i), \quad i = 1, \dots, p.$$

*M-product

Let $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n \times p}$, $\mathcal{B} \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times k \times p}$ and $M \in \mathbb{R}^{p \times p}$. Then the *M-product of tensors $\mathcal{A}$ and $\mathcal{B}$ is denoted by $\mathcal{A} *_M \mathcal{B} \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times k \times p}$ and defined as

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SVD in the framework of $\ast$ M-product⁸

Let $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n \times p}$ and $M \in \mathbb{R}^{p \times p}$ be an invertible matrix. Then, there exist orthogonal tensors $\mathcal{U} \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times m \times p}$ and $\mathcal{V} \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n \times p}$ such that

$$\mathcal{A} = \mathcal{U} \ast_M \Sigma \ast_M \mathcal{V}^T,$$

where $\Sigma \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n \times p}$ is F -diagonal tensor.

⁸Kilmer, M. E.; Horesh, L.; Avron, H.; Newman, E., *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 118 (2021), e2015851118.

Extension to Higher Dimension

Einstein product

Let $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{I_1 \times \cdots \times I_M \times J_1 \times \cdots \times J_N}$ and $\mathcal{B} \in \mathbb{R}^{J_1 \times \cdots \times J_N \times K_1 \times \cdots \times K_L}$. Then,

$$(\mathcal{A} *_N \mathcal{B})_{i_1 i_2 \dots i_M k_1 k_2 \dots k_L} = \sum_{j_1, j_2, \dots, j_N=1}^{J_1, J_2, \dots, J_N} a_{i_1 i_2 \dots i_M j_1 j_2 \dots j_N} b_{j_1 j_2 \dots j_N k_1 k_2 \dots k_L}.$$

Extension to Higher Dimension

Tensor transpose⁹

Let $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{I_1 \times I_2 \times \cdots \times I_M \times J_1 \times J_2 \times \cdots \times J_N}$. Then the transpose of the tensor $\mathcal{A}$, denoted by $\mathcal{A}^T$, is a tensor in $\mathbb{R}^{J_1 \times J_2 \times \cdots \times J_N \times I_1 \times I_2 \times \cdots \times I_M}$ and defined elementwise,

$$\mathcal{A}_{j_1 j_2 \dots j_N i_1 i_2 \dots i_M}^T = \mathcal{A}_{i_1 i_2 \dots i_M j_1 j_2 \dots j_N}.$$

Einstein product

Let $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{I_1 \times \cdots \times I_M \times J_1 \times \cdots \times J_N}$ and $\mathcal{B} \in \mathbb{R}^{J_1 \times \cdots \times J_N \times K_1 \times \cdots \times K_L}$. Then,

$$(\mathcal{A} *_N \mathcal{B})_{i_1 i_2 \dots i_M k_1 k_2 \dots k_L} = \sum_{j_1, j_2, \dots, j_N=1}^{J_1, J_2, \dots, J_N} a_{i_1 i_2 \dots i_M j_1 j_2 \dots j_N} b_{j_1 j_2 \dots j_N k_1 k_2 \dots k_L}.$$

⁹Sun, L.; Zheng, B.; Bu, C.; Wei, Y., *Linear Multilinear Algebra* 64 (2016), 686-698

SVD framed in Einstein product¹⁰

For a tensor $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{I_1 \times \cdots \times I_N \times J_1 \times \cdots \times J_N}$, the SVD of $\mathcal{A}$ has the form as

$$\mathcal{A} = \mathcal{U} *_N \mathcal{B} *_N \mathcal{V}^T,$$

where $\mathcal{U} \in \mathbb{R}^{I_1 \times \cdots \times I_N \times I_1 \times \cdots \times I_N}$ and $\mathcal{V} \in \mathbb{R}^{J_1 \times \cdots \times J_N \times J_1 \times \cdots \times J_N}$ are orthogonal tensors, $\mathcal{B} \in \mathbb{R}^{I_1 \times \cdots \times I_N \times J_1 \times \cdots \times J_N}$ is a diagonal tensor.

¹⁰Sun, L.; Zheng, B.; Bu, C.; Wei, Y., [Linear Multilinear Algebra](#) 64 (2016), 686-698

Moore–Penrose inverse¹¹(Einstein product)

Let $\mathcal{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{I_1 \times I_2 \times \cdots \times I_N \times J_1 \times J_2 \times \cdots \times J_N}$. Then there exists a unique tensor $\mathcal{X} \in \mathbb{R}^{J_1 \times J_2 \times \cdots \times J_N \times I_1 \times I_2 \times \cdots \times I_N}$ such that

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{A} *_N \mathcal{X} *_N \mathcal{A} &= \mathcal{A}; \\ \mathcal{X} *_N \mathcal{A} *_N \mathcal{X} &= \mathcal{X}; \\ (\mathcal{A} *_N \mathcal{X})^T &= \mathcal{A} *_N \mathcal{X}; \\ (\mathcal{X} *_N \mathcal{A})^T &= \mathcal{X} *_N \mathcal{A}.\end{aligned}$$

¹¹Sun, L.; Zheng, B.; Bu, C.; Wei, Y., *Linear Multilinear Algebra* 64 (2016), 686-698

Thank You!